

brightness of the image, or by setting a high ISO. However, both these methods end up churning out noisy images. This does not mean that good action or sport photos can be taken only in this mode. Choosing a wider aperture, and a mid-range shutter speed, and then tracking a moving object with the camera can often provide good results with the subject in focus and the background blurred in movement.

Aperture priority/preferred (Av):

The aperture priority mode, is used to manually set a depth of field in your camera, while the camera automatically does the rest. The depth of field decides which aspect of the frame is in focus. A large depth of field means that everything in the frame will be in focus, from subjects close to the camera to details in the background. This setting is used for landscape photos. A small depth of field means that, say, a subject close to the camera will be in sharp focus, whereas the background will be out of focus.

There is a whole range of depth of field settings between these two settings that a user may experiment with. The aperture is measured in f-stops, and a large f-stop number reduces the amount of light that comes in, but creates a large depth of field. Using a large f-stop number also means that there will be a fast shutter speed and a large ISO setting, which might bring noise into the story. A small f-stop number increases the amount of light that comes in and produces a small depth of field; also, the shutter speed is reduced, so the camera has to be held steady while using this setting. As the shutter speed is reduced, this setting also uses a proportionally smaller ISO setting. The camera automatically adjusts the white balance as well.

Aquarium:

The aquarium mode uses a fast shutter speed at high ISO settings to capture moving fish in low-light conditions. The reflection of the flash from the glass of the tank is automatically suppressed, and the white balance is set to tone down the blues to bring out the natural colours in the aquarium. This mode is available in a few Canon cameras.